

React.js Quick Start Guide

A concise beginner-friendly walkthrough of React essentials

1 What is React.js?

React is a JavaScript library for building fast, interactive user interfaces. It follows a component-based approach, letting developers build reusable pieces of UI that update dynamically as data changes — making it a popular choice for modern web applications.

2 Why React?

- Component-based architecture
- Reusable UI
- Fast development
- Large ecosystem
- Easy interactive interfaces

3 React Application Flow



React re-renders only what changes, keeping the UI fast and responsive.

4 JSX & Components

- JSX lets you write HTML-like syntax inside JavaScript.
- Components are reusable UI building blocks.
- Modern React primarily uses functional components.

```
function Welcome() {  
  return <h1>Hello React!</h1>;  
}
```

Core React Concepts

Understanding how data flows and updates in React

1 Props

Props pass data from a parent component to a child. They are read-only inside the child.

```
function User({ name }) {  
  return <h2>Hello {name}</h2>;  
}
```

2 State

State stores data managed inside a component. Updating it causes the UI to re-render.

```
const [count, setCount] = useState(0);
```

3 Hooks

- **useState()** — adds and updates state in a functional component.
- **useEffect()** — runs side effects like data fetching after render.

4 Quick Comparison

Concept	Description
Props	Data received from parent
State	Data managed inside component
JSX	UI syntax inside JavaScript
Hooks	Features used inside functional components

5 Mini Practice Task

Create a simple Counter component using useState()

1. Create a count state with an initial value of 0.

2. Add + and – buttons to update the count.

3. Display the current count in the UI.

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